delegation led by the Aga Khan appearing before the Joint Committee of both Houses of Parliament. This delegation was appointed to consider the proposals embodied in the White Paper on Indian constitutional reforms released by the Government in March 1932. Lord Linlithgow, who was to become Viceroy of India, was the Chairman of the Joint Committee.

At the second Round Table Conference, Purshotamdas was accepted as the natural spokesman in economic and financial matters. His most important achievement at the third Round Table Conference was his effort to save India's gold reserves. The Conference had appointed a committee to study the feasibility of starting a Reserve Bank of India. An important question before the Committee was: What proportion of India's currency reserves should be in the form of gold and how much in the form of sterling securities? Sir Henry Strakosch, Sir Cecil Kisch, and Sir Reginald Mant, the trinity of British finance, believed that this question should be left to the discretion of the Reserve Bank who could decide in what form it wanted to hold its reserves. Purshotamdas firmly believed that the ₹45 crore worth of gold (at the pre-war rate of £5 per ounce) which the government held should be the minimum gold reserve maintained by the Bank. Purshotamdas declared emphatically that this was required to inspire confidence among the Indian public and that it would be disastrous to disregard Indian sentiment. He warned that the government would be hard put to meet a run by the public if they wanted to change their notes into hard rupees. Arguing that it was difficult for a foreigner to understand Indian financial conservatism, he asked if the Committee was devising a Reserve Bank for the approval of foreign countries or for inspiring confidence among the people of India.

Purshotamdas's fervent appeal and sound line of reasoning seems to have had some effect on Sir George Schuster who asked Sir Reginald Mant to postpone the discussion. When the Committee resumed discussions, Schuster stated that he agreed in principle with Purshotamdas and suggested that ₹30 crores in gold be earmarked for the purpose. While the other Indian members were prepared to agree at what they believed was a reasonable offer from the Finance Member, Purshotamdas refused to relent. Schuster then stepped up the figure to ₹35 crores but Purshotamdas still could not be won over. At that time Purshotamdas overheard an Indian representative remark to his neighbour that Purshotamdas was a stubborn man and would